KALE REALTY

76% VS. 53%. THE AFFORDABILITY MATH FLIPPED.

Boomers felt confident about their payment.
Millennials mostly don't.

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76% OF BOOMER HOMEOWNERS SAY THEY CAN EASILY AFFORD THEIR MORTGAGE PAYMENT. ONLY 53% OF MILLENNIALS SAY THE SAME.

Millennials now out-earn boomers at the same age.

03 / 05

IT ISN'T INCOME. IT'S THE PAYMENT ITSELF.

Redfin's survey with Ipsos (4,000 U.S. residents, November 2026) found 76% of boomer homeowners say they can easily afford their mortgage payment, compared with 53% of millennials. Separately, Redfin's own price analysis found the typical millennial homeowner in their early 40s pays about $3,000 a month in 2025 dollars, versus about $1,986 for boomers at the same age. Census data in the same report puts millennial household income at a comparable age at about $100,000, versus $88,000 for boomers. The paycheck grew. The payment grew faster.

WHAT TO DO WITH THAT THIS MONTH:

1 **Show the payment, not just the price.**
A buyer comparing today's rate to a parent's old rate is comparing two different worlds, not two different budgets.

2 **Put the real monthly number in writing before the first showing.**
A pre-approval with the actual payment stops sticker shock three showings in.

3 **Separate income from affordability in the conversation.**
A buyer who out-earns their parents at this age and still feels priced out is reading the math correctly, not failing at it.

THE TAKEAWAY

HERE'S WHAT YOU DO NOW.

Before your next buyer meeting, run the real payment first. The house didn't get less affordable by accident. The payment did.

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